

Adithya Athreya Venkateswaran

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EDUCATION

INSEAD	2021–2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Marketing (Quantitative Marketing)	
Committee: Paulo Albuquerque (Chair), Maria Ana Vitorino, Varun Karamshetty	
University of Georgia, Terry College of Business	2019
Master of Marketing Research	
National Institute of Technology, Tiruchirappalli	2011–2015
Bachelor of Technology in Civil Engineering	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Associate, Indian School of Business (Hyderabad, India)	2019–2021
Research assistant to Sundar Bharadwaj on artificial intelligence and demand for marketing skills.	
Business Analyst, Market Research, ZS Associates (Pune, India)	2015–2018
Specialized in pharmaceutical market research, with a focus on oncology and immunology.	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am a **quantitative marketing scholar** studying how digital platforms make pricing and resource-allocation decisions, and how these choices affect consumer behavior and welfare, with applications in healthcare and on matchmaking platforms.

- **Substantive:** Healthcare Marketing; Matchmaking Platforms; Marketing Resource Allocation; Subscription Pricing; Platform Monetization; Marketing and Society.
- **Methods:** Structural Econometrics; Causal Inference; Bayesian Statistics.

WORKING PAPERS

1. Adithya A. Venkateswaran, Varun Karamshetty, and Paulo Albuquerque, “Performance Marketing and Health Outcomes in Medical Crowdfunding,” preparing for submission to Management Science; Job Market Paper.
2. Adithya A. Venkateswaran, Khwan Kim, and Manav Raj, “Who’s Coming to Dinner? How Subscription Business Models Affect Platform Participation.” *Submitted to Management Science*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

3. Adithya A. Venkateswaran, “Access Pricing and Adverse Selection in Networked Experience Goods”.

4. Adithya A. Venkateswaran, Varun Karamshetty, and Paulo Albuquerque, “Does Earmarking Generate Greater Platform Revenue under Pay-What-You-Want Pricing? Evidence from a Digital Fundraising Platform”.
5. Adithya A. Venkateswaran and Sundar Bharadwaj, “Generative AI and Demand for Marketing Jobs and Skills”.
6. Adithya A. Venkateswaran and Pavel Kireyev, "When Sellers Curate: Portfolio Preferences, Pricing, and Platform Revenue in Digital Art Markets".

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Doctoral Fellowship, Marketing Department, INSEAD	2021–Present
MMR Merit Scholarship, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia	2018–2019

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

Selected Participant, ISMS Doctoral Consortium, Carcavelos, Portugal	June 2026
“Performance Marketing and Health Outcomes in Medical Crowdfunding”	
Presenter, ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Carcavelos, Portugal	June 2026
“Performance Marketing and Health Outcomes in Medical Crowdfunding”	
JACR Conference, Fontainebleau, France	October 2023
“The Metaverse: Consumer Behavior and Well-Being”	
INSEAD Marketing PhD Research Seminar, Fontainebleau, France	2022–2025
Presenter, ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Rochester, United States (Virtual)	June 2021
“Impact of AI on Marketing Jobs and Skills”	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, INSEAD Executive Education	April 2022
Leading the Effective Salesforce; course preparation (Professor: Leonard Lodish)	

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming: R (primary), Python, Stata, MATLAB
Tools: LaTeX, Git, high-performance computing, ChatGPT Codex, Claude Code
Languages: English (fluent), Tamil (native), Hindi (fluent)

REFERENCES

Paulo Albuquerque, Professor of Marketing, INSEAD
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Maria Ana Vitorino, Associate Professor of Marketing, INSEAD
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Varun Karamshetty, Assistant Professor, Department of Information Systems and Analytics, NUS
School of Computing
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JOB MARKET PAPER

“Performance Marketing and Health Outcomes in Medical Crowdfunding”

with Varun Karamshetty and Paulo Albuquerque; Preparing for submission to *Management Science*

Digital platforms routinely allocate marketing resources using short-term performance metrics, such as clicks or conversions, that capture consumer preference. On crowdfunding platforms, each conversion contributes to the fundraising campaign of an identifiable beneficiary and, in turn, shapes downstream outcomes for that beneficiary. Whether allocating resources based on what the donor side rewards also maximizes impact on beneficiary outcomes is therefore an empirical question. We study this question in the context of medical crowdfunding by developing the marketing-to-health (M2H) chain, which traces how platform marketing decisions impact patient health outcomes through three sequential links: marketing affects donations, timely donations affect treatment timing, and treatment timing shapes patient health trajectories. We combine these links into the Health Return on Marketing (HROM), a marginal health return metric to guide marketing allocation decisions. We estimate the M2H chain using proprietary data from one of India’s largest medical crowdfunding platforms, exploiting institutional and regulatory features of the setting that generate plausibly exogenous variation in marketing exposure and in the fundraising–treatment timing relationship. We simulate budget-neutral allocation policies that take into account both donation performance and health impact. We find that donation-maximizing allocation is substantially misaligned with health impact: health-aware reallocation improves patient welfare by up to 14% relative to the donation-maximizing policy. Moreover, the donation–health frontier is concave, implying that platform managers need not abandon fundraising performance to improve patient health: a policy that trades off only 2.5% of donations improves patient welfare by 9.1%. Incorporating outcome-based returns into marketing allocation can thus meaningfully improve real-world outcomes whenever short-term consumer responses differ in their downstream impact.

WORKING PAPER

“Subscription Business Models and the Reliability Paradox: Evidence from a Social Matchmaking Platform”

with Khwan Kim and Manav Raj; Preparing for submission to *Management Science* by the end of July

Platforms face an important strategic choice in how they monetize user access. Subscription-only business models screen for committed users, but may also shape how users behave once they have subscribed, as commitment to the platform may not translate into reliable participation in the experiences the platform organizes. We study this tradeoff using proprietary data from Timeleft, a global social dining platform that matches strangers into groups for weekly dinners, exploiting the staggered rollout of subscription-only pricing across 30 cities. We find that removing the pay-per-use option reduces new-user acquisition while increasing short-run retention, consistent with effective screening. At the same time, subscription-only access increases no-shows and cancellations, even among incumbent users who were already active before the policy change. These reliability failures may impose local externalities, as exposure to no-show tablemates is associated with a decrease in co-participants' experience ratings and predicts subsequent no-show behavior. Despite these reliability costs, the subscription-only model increases observed social engagement, measured by likes sent and reciprocated likes among tablemates, primarily through

compositional changes in who attends. The findings show that platform monetization is a governance lever that shapes who participates, how reliably they participate, and how value is created in platform-mediated interactions.

“Access Pricing and Adverse Selection in Networked Experience Goods”

Work in Progress

When firms sell shared experiences, pricing structure shapes not only who enters but the product itself, because customers are part of what other customers consume. Subscription pricing may screen for committed customers and improve retention, yet it also changes the participant pool from which experiences are assembled, and may alter how customers behave after entry. Using data from a social dining platform where we observe contract choice, booking, and realized attendance, we estimate a structural model that separates customers’ product valuation from their outside-option quality. The identification exploits a key feature of subscription: booking is costless because the fee is sunk, so booking reveals valuation while the gap between booking and attendance reveals the strength of outside alternatives. The central finding is that customers who value the platform most also tend to have the strongest outside alternatives: they subscribe and remain engaged, but their rich outside options make them less likely to follow through after booking. We evaluate alternative per-use, subscription, and hybrid pricing menus alongside governance mechanisms such as attendance deposits. We show that interventions designed to counter subscription’s reliability costs can backfire in the presence of this adverse selection, as they risk driving away precisely the high-valuation customers most attracted to subscription access.